

// TUTORIAL //

How To Copy Files With Rsync Over SSH

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Linux Basics



Bulat Khamitov



Step 1 - Setup public SSH keys

On our origin server, we will generate public SSH keys with no password:

```
ssh-keygen -f ~/.ssh/id_rsa -q -P "" cat ~/.ssh/id_rsa.pub
```

This is our public SSH key that can be placed on other hosts to give us access:

```
ssh-rsa AAAAB3NzaC1yc2EAAAADAQABAAQDLVDBIpdpfePg/  
a6h8au1HTKPPrg8wuTrjdh0QFVPpTI4KHctf6/FGg1N0gM++hrDlbrDVStKn/b3Mu65//  
tuvY5SG9sR4vrINCSQF+
```

```
+a+YRTGU6Sn4ltKpyj3usHERvBndtFXoDxsYKRCtPfgm1BGTBpoSl2A7lrwnmVSg+u11F0a1xSZ  
CF0IJCqeXG6s+qVfRjB root@cloudads
```

Copy this key to your clipboard and login to your destination server.

Place this SSH key into your `~/.ssh/authorized_keys` file:

If your SSH folder does not exist, create it manually:

```
mkdir ~/.ssh chmod 0700 ~/.ssh touch ~/.ssh/authorized_keys chmod 0644  
~/.ssh/authorized_keys
```

Step 3 - Rsync files over

Rsync is a great utility, as it allows you, among many other things, to copy files recursively with compression, and over an encrypted channel.

We will copy a file from our origin server (198.211.117.101) in `/root/bigfile.txt` over to our destination server (IP: 198.211.117.129) and save it in `/root/bigfile.txt` as well.

Login on 198.211.117.101 and rsync the file over to 198.211.117.129:

```
rsync -avz -e "ssh -o StrictHostKeyChecking=no -o UserKnownHostsFile=  
dev/null" --progress /root/bigfile.txt 198.211.117.129:/root/
```

If you are using a different user, for example "username" then you would have to append it in front of destination server. Make sure to have your public key in that user's `~/.ssh/authorized_keys` file:

```
rsync -avz -e "ssh -o StrictHostKeyChecking=no -o UserKnownHostsFile=  
dev/null" --progress /root/bigfile.txt username@198.211.117.129:/
```

The SSH options are useful to keep Rsync quiet and not prompting everytime you connect to a new server.

Verify that you have received the file on destination server (198.211.117.129):

```
ls -la /root/bigfile.txt
```

And you are all done!

By Bulat Khamitov